

tions. You can scan (view) videos at high or low speeds, to help you reach a particular scene in a clip much faster. It also allows you to make very nice-looking DVD menus, and includes over 140 transitions and over 50 effect filters. And, finally, when you're ready to output your work, you can choose from almost any video format—including MPEG-1 or 2, Real Media, QuickTime, Windows Media, and even DivX!

The software also claims to render much faster than its competitors, though unless you have a very powerful system, all of these software will seem to take eons anyway! The capture quality is good though, and seems a little better than its competitors here. Capture is possible from camcorders, analogue signals (TV-Tuner cards / analogue camcorders), webcams, and, of course, importing video from the hard drive.

Overall, this seems to be the best video editing software out there, and at \$10 less than its competition, is sure to appeal to us frugal Indians—especially when you consider that it's a very powerful video editing software.

4.2.3 Ulead Video Studio

This is another hundred-dollar software, like Adobe Premiere Elements, and to be honest, despite the fact that it's about \$10 more expensive than PowerDirector, we still consider it to be a good deal—that's how feature rich it is!

Why do we make such a bold statement? Well, consider that apart from video editing, this software will also allow you to create 3D images for use in Macromedia (now Adobe) Flash, movie screensavers, and supports all Internet-friendly file formats and compression techniques.

Despite the additional options, the software layout is good, and everything is easily accessible. Capturing is made easier by using a Wizard, which automatically detects your camcorder and begins importing video automatically. The software is smart enough to